

Four minutes, **ten slides.**

What to say on every slide, **29 September.**

Kat Titterton · San Francisco · 25 September 2026

Run of show · 29 Sept

Four minutes, ten slides, about 530 spoken words. The spine: **self, us, now** (02, 03), then **why, how, what** (04, 05, 06), then **who else, where it goes, the ask** (07–10). 07 and 08 are the fastest stretch: two beats, one point.

SLIDE	CLOCK	SEC	CLICKS	BEAT	ONE LINE TO LAND
01 Control is an illusion	0:00–0:12	12	1	hook	Confidence without control.
02 Founder	0:12–0:40	28	1	self	This is the thing I kept needing and nobody sold.
03 Do my cells look normal?	0:40–1:05	25	1	us, now	Cells are the input nobody certifies.
04 One lab, or six?	1:05–1:45	40	3	why now	The model isn't the hard part. The reference is.
05 It passed every check	1:45–2:20	35	3	how	Your own past is not a reference. The field is.
06 The product	2:20–2:45	25	1	what	Four months becomes one day.
07 Identity, yes. Behaviour, no.	2:45–2:55	10	1	who else	The other half of the certificate.

SLIDE	CLOCK	SEC	CLICKS	BEAT	ONE LINE TO LAND
08 Identity is solved	2:55– 3:10	15	1	who buys	Nobody sells the behaviour half.
09 The ugliest dataset in biology	3:10– 3:35	25	1	the build	Name the failure, not just flag it.
10 Every plate, placed in the field	3:35– 4:00	25	0	vision, ask	Have images of U2OS cells? Talk to me.

Captions stay hidden while you present (Tweaks › captions); the shared link and PDF show them. If you're late at 2:20, cut the "why now" sentence on 04 and the "who pays" line on 06.

01 Control is an illusion (0:00–0:12)

On screen while you're introduced. Let the dial drift.

0:00 Hi, I'm Kat. Every result in biology is a difference from a control, and nobody checks the control. So I'm building confidence without it. *Point at the pink dot, then the green ring. Click.*

02 Founder (0:12–0:40)

Self. Let the pink employer names do the credential work.

0:12 I've built imaging assays at AbbVie, MIT, insitro and Axiom, and at every bench I've asked the same question: do my cells look normal?

0:20 At Axiom we onboarded primary hepatocytes. Counts were stable; every plate looked like the last. Four months in, we compared with the Broad's images: the CRO had been spinning the cells down unevenly. No count could see it. Only somebody else's images could.

0:35 This is the thing I kept needing and nobody sold. *Click.*

Precision to hold. "Published with" lists coauthor institutions, never partners. Tell the Axiom story as what happened, not how it was fixed.

03 Do my cells look normal? (0:40–1:05)

Us, then now. Point at the pink slice, then the month-4 dot.

0:40 This isn't my problem; it's all of ours. About twenty-eight billion dollars a year of US preclinical research can't be reproduced, and the biggest slice, about a third, is inputs.

0:52 For us, one unchecked line cost seventeen weeks of screening, about 2.6 million dollars. Cells are the input nobody certifies. *Click.*

Precision to hold. \$28B is a 2015 US estimate; the 36% covers all reagents and reference materials, not only cells.

04 One lab, or six? (1:05–1:45, three clicks)

Why now. State 1 is a game: let the room look for four seconds.

1:05 Six untreated wells. Same line, same protocol, no drug. One lab, or six? *Beat. Click.*

1:15 Six labs. Nobody here can tell; a classifier can, ninety-six percent of the time, against fourteen by chance. The pink one fools it. *Click.*

1:28 Why now: this data is public, eleven sites, free, and embeddings are a commodity. Same-size nuclei, different texture: that's what moves the point. The model isn't the hard part. The reference is. *Click.*

Precision to hold. Seven institutions, 12,046 wells, held out by plate; shuffled labels score 15.2%. Cell Painting fluorescence; brightfield is the bet.

05 It passed every check (1:45–2:20, three clicks)

How. Dark slide: slow down.

1:45 One plate. Everything its own lab can see says fine. *Click.*

1:52 It's labelled lab 2. Zero of its 384 untreated wells look like lab 2. *Click.*

2:02 And even one lab drifts: runs three months apart sit three times further apart than runs on the same day, then it plateaus. Your own past is not a reference. The field is. *Click.*

For ML people. Batch correction takes lab identity from 96% to 12%: right for discovery, wrong for QC.

06 Know on day one, not month four (2:20–2:45)

What. Walk the four icons left to right.

2:20 The product: brightfield images of the control wells you already take. They stay yours. We place them against the field. One answer in a day: in or out, and which features moved.

2:35 Cores risk the paper, pharma the screen, cell banks the lot. Four months becomes one day. *Click.*

07 Identity, yes. Behaviour, no. (2:45–2:55)

Point at the "run STR" cell. One sentence.

2:45 STR proves which line you have. Nothing proves it behaves like everyone else's. *Click.*

08 Identity is solved (2:55–3:10)

Who buys. Let the column of pink ticks speak.

2:55 Every institution onboarding a line has this problem: cores, pharma and CROs, cell banks and vendors. STR is a collaborator, not a rival. Nobody sells the behaviour half. *Click.*

Note. 07 and 08 make the same point twice. If you need ten seconds back, skip 07 and say its line here.

09 The ugliest dataset in biology (3:10–3:35)

The build. This is the blank-cheque answer, said before anyone asks.

3:10 If someone wrote the cheque, I'd build the ugliest dataset in biology, on purpose: many lines, plate types and objectives, and failures planted deliberately. Bubbles, focus failures, clipped wells, bad metadata.

3:23 Then every method has to say not just that something is wrong, but which thing. A foundation other people can stand on, instead of Google Images. *Click.*

10 Every plate, placed in the field (3:35–4:00)

Vision, then the ask. Read the headline, then the right card.

3:35 That's the vision: every plate you image, placed in the field, without anyone lifting a finger. Next it tells you what to change, then flags a bad lot across every lab using it.

3:47 What I need: images, U2OS first; ML people better than me; bench time; and a pre-seed to run it. If you run a cell line somebody else also runs, you already have the data.

3:57 Have images of U2OS cells? Talk to me. *Stop.*

Precision to hold. Price and test-set budget are not set: say "per line, per quarter" and "the proof of concept sets the size". Don't name a partner lab until one has agreed.